

STAGE THREE • JOB APPLICATION & INTERVIEW SKILLS

FIRSTS

SESSION DEBRIEF / CLOSE-OUT SCRIPT

How to end each session, summarize, and bridge to what's next

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

BY AYOMIDE AYENI

FIRSTS • Session Debrief / Close-Out Script

Stage Three • Job Application & Interview Skills

WHY THIS MATTERS

A genuine close-out does three things every time: names what was actually accomplished, connects it forward to what's next, and gives a specific, concrete action to take before the next session. This stage in particular benefits from closing on an encouraging, forward-looking note, given how much of the material touches on rejection and anxiety.

Close-Out Scripts

SESSION 1

Closing Session 1

"Today you built the real operational core of a job search: a tracker, a genuine strategy, tested resume versions, tailored cover letters, listing analysis, and your core STAR and behavioral stories."

"Notice that everything from here forward assumes this foundation is in place. Your interview answers in Session 2 will draw directly on the stories you built today."

"Before next time: bring those stories with you. We're going to test them under real pressure."

SESSION 2

Closing Session 2

"That was intensive — technical prep, case practice, a full mock interview, negotiation practice, and more. You performed under real conditions today, not just planned in the abstract."

"If any part of today felt uncomfortable, that discomfort is doing real work. It's much better to feel it here, with people who want you to improve, than for the first time in an actual interview."

"Before next time: if you have a real, active job search underway, bring your current deadlines and any pending follow-ups. Our final session is about staying organized and closing strong."

SESSION 3

Closing Session 3 (Stage Close)

"That's Stage Three, complete. You've built the full arc: tracking and strategy, tailored materials, core stories, interview performance under real conditions, negotiation practice, and now the systems that keep everything organized — mindset, follow-up, deadlines, research, and a clear-headed way to compare real offers."

"The uncomfortable parts of this stage — rejection, mock interviews, negotiation — don't fully go away with practice, but your tolerance and skill for handling them well genuinely does grow. That's what today was building."

"Before we close: name one specific thing from this stage you're going to use in your very next real application or interview — not someday, the next one."

"Stage Four picks up with Mindset, Productivity & Habits — the sustained discipline that carries you through a job search that might take longer than you'd like, and into whatever comes after you land the role."